

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 7 4 2

♥ 9 7 4 3

♦ 8 7

♣ Q J 2

♠ A 10 6

♥ K J 2

♦ A 10 5 3

♣ K 8 5



♠ J 5 3

♥ Q 10 6

♦ K 6 2

♣ A 10 6 4

♠ K 9 8

♥ A 8 5

♦ Q J 9 4

♣ 9 7 3

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

with the ♦K he will be unlikely to lead another ♣, which would be too bad for your side.

[showcards W:C4 N:C3]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♣4, dummy played the ♣3

Third-hand-high is usually a good plan to follow, certainly that is true in this deal. But that doesn't mean you should blindly play your HIGHEST card, rather you should play the LOWEST of high-equals.

In other words, in this case you should play the ♣J, which is equal to the ♣Q.

If instead you play the ♣Q, figuring it makes no difference, you'd be right that it makes no difference to you. But partner would then assume that it is declarer with the ♣J, and when he obtains the lead

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 7 3

♥ 10 5

♦ A 5 4 2

♣ 8 4 2

♠ J 6 4

♥ Q 8

♦ K 9 7 3

♣ K Q J 10



♠ K 10 2

♥ 6 4 3

♦ Q J 10 6

♣ A 6 5

♠ A 9 5

♥ A K J 9 7 2

♦ 8

♣ 9 7 3

West	North	East	South
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Pass	2♣	Pass	1♥
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Pass	4♥		
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All Pass

4♥ by South

he can only make one ♠ trick when you play correctly.

[showcards W:S3 N:S4]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠3, dummy played the ♠4

Play the ♠10.

Partner's low ♠ lead tells you that he has an honor in the suit. There are only two ♠ honors you can't see, and you know he wouldn't underlead an Ace at a suit contract. So partner holds the ♠Q.

You can see clearly what would happen if you played Third-hand-high and put on your ♠K. Declarer would win his ♠A and could then set up a second ♠ trick by leading toward dummy's ♠J.

By playing the ♠10 you force declarer to win with the ♠A if he wants the trick. But however he plays

For your side, 2 ♠ tricks and the two minor Aces spell defeat.